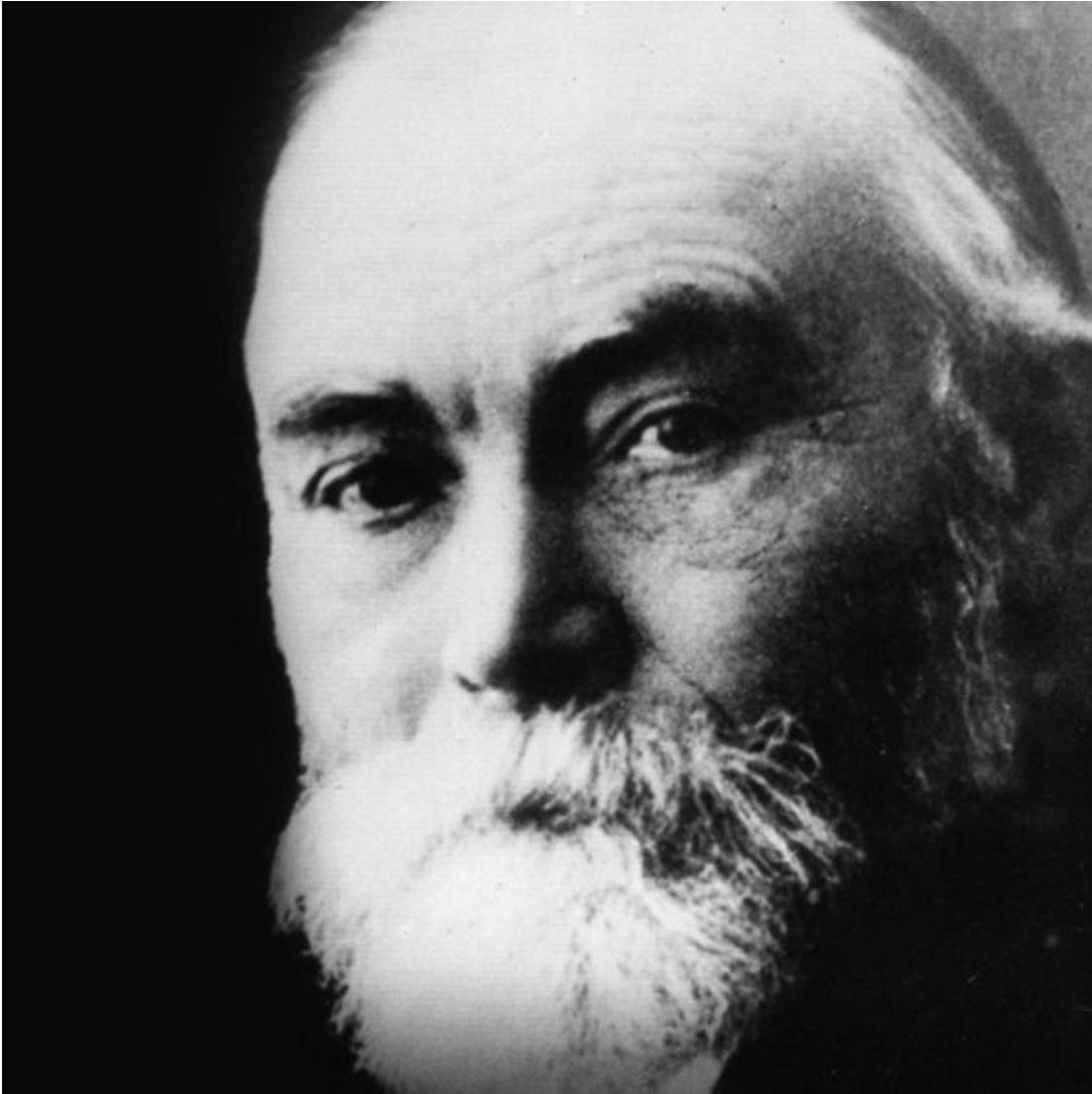


Logic vs epistemology



Frege's insight that logic is not a creation of the human mind, but consists of universal objective truths, had profound implications for philosophy. Mathematics, he said, followed the same principles as logic, and so was equally objective. But the process of reasoning that underlies philosophy is also a series of arguments and demonstrations, governed by logical principles and is similarly not a human creation. Philosophical truths should therefore be objective, and discoverable in the same way that we can discover the truths of mathematics, independent of the way our minds work.

Much of modern philosophy, however, has been based on epistemology, the study of how we know what we know, and what we *can* know, all of which concerns what is going on in our minds and is effectively irrelevant to philosophical truth. For philosophy to discover objective truths about our knowledge, it now became clear, it must have its foundations in logic, not epistemology.